

JOB DESCRIPTION

VP of Manufacturing

Wise

CENTRAL IDEA OF THE POSITION

The VP of Manufacturing creates one Wise Manufacturing System operating through five plants and builds the manufacturing platform for the next stage of Wise's label and packaging growth.

Position Purpose

Responsible for manufacturing performance supporting Wise's existing repeat-revenue business across all five plants, while building the manufacturing capabilities necessary to support significant label and packaging revenue growth.

The VP of Manufacturing leads Wise manufacturing primarily through the five Plant General Managers. The GMs remain accountable for daily plant execution; the VP is accountable for the enterprise manufacturing system, standards, continuous improvement, leadership development, network capacity, manufacturing capability, and strategic execution.

Scope and Reporting

- Reports to the CEO.
- Responsible for manufacturing across all five Wise plants, including business forms and label production.
- Leads primarily through the five Plant General Managers.
- Partners closely with Sales, Finance, Human Resources, IT, Supply Chain/Purchasing, and other leadership functions.
- Provides enterprise leadership for manufacturing strategy, standards, systems, talent, capacity, capital equipment, and continuous improvement.

Strategic Priorities

1. Build and Deploy the Wise Manufacturing System

- Lead the Lean rollout across all five plants as Wise's operating system for continuous improvement.
- Develop standard work, processes, management systems, and operating disciplines that can be proven in one location and rolled out across all plants.
- Identify best demonstrated practices within Wise, convert them into repeatable standards, and systematically deploy them across the manufacturing network.
- Establish a consistent daily and weekly management system using visual management, standard work, problem solving, constraint management, and accountability.
- Build a culture in which GMs, supervisors, and operators continuously improve the work rather than rely on management firefighting.

2. Accelerate Label and Packaging Manufacturing Growth

- Make label and packaging manufacturing capability a primary strategic focus because of Wise's desired label revenue growth.
- Lead the growth and implementation of label and packaging manufacturing capabilities within existing Wise plants.
- Determine which products and processes should be manufactured at each plant based on capability, capacity, service, economics, and growth requirements.
- Develop the manufacturing roadmap required to support Sales growth, including equipment, people, training, systems, quality standards, workflow, and capacity.

- Evaluate, select, justify, install, and successfully ramp new label, packaging, printing, converting, and related manufacturing equipment.
- Ensure new capabilities can be produced profitably, with competitive lead times, repeatable quality, and reliable delivery.
- Create clear capacity triggers and investment criteria for when additional manufacturing capability or equipment should be added.

3. Strengthen Plant Leadership

- Hire, onboard, and develop the Anderson Plant General Manager.
- Set clear expectations for all five GMs and hold them accountable for plant execution, people development, continuous improvement, and results.
- Develop the GMs as a cohesive Wise manufacturing leadership team that shares best practices and solves enterprise problems together.
- Build leadership depth and succession plans for key manufacturing positions, including GMs, supervisors, technical leaders, and critical operators.

4. Improve Manufacturing Performance Across the Network

- Improve throughput, lead time, on-time delivery, quality, labor productivity, equipment effectiveness, and waste across all plants.
- Use common scorecards and plant-to-plant benchmarking to identify performance gaps and establish what is possible.
- Focus improvement activity on the constraints that most limit lead time, throughput, customer service, capacity and profitable growth.
- Drive systematic improvement in press speeds, makeready time, uptime, scheduling, maintenance, staffing, and material flow.
- Protect and improve the manufacturing performance supporting Wise's existing repeat-revenue business while building capacity for growth.

Key Responsibilities

Enterprise Manufacturing Leadership

- Establish and execute Wise's manufacturing strategy across all five plants.
- Create common manufacturing standards while allowing appropriate local flexibility when product, equipment, or customer requirements differ.
- Balance work and capacity across the plant network when enterprise service, throughput, or economics can be improved.
- Ensure manufacturing priorities are aligned with Wise's overall strategy and growth objectives.
- Identify systemic issues that affect multiple plants and lead permanent countermeasures rather than repeated local workarounds.

Lean and Continuous Improvement

- Lead the implementation and maturation of Lean/Toyota Production System principles throughout Wise manufacturing.
- Develop and sustain standard work and leader standard work.
- Drive SMED and makeready reduction, especially in high-mix, low-volume printing environments.
- Establish disciplined problem solving, root-cause analysis, kaizen, visual management, and daily accountability.
- Develop plant capability to identify and improve constraints using throughput-focused thinking.
- Measure Lean success through operational results and improved problem-solving capability, not simply completion of Lean activities.

Manufacturing Systems and Standardization

- Document, standardize, and deploy effective manufacturing processes across all plants.
- Create repeatable systems for including but not limited to scheduling, job release, press preparation, makeready, run standards, quality checks, maintenance, operator training, and performance review.

- Use pilot-and-deploy methods: test improvements where appropriate, prove the result, standardize the method, and expand it across Wise.
- Ensure standards are visible, practical, trainable, measurable, and owned by plant leadership.

Equipment, Capacity, and Capital

- Develop an enterprise view of manufacturing capacity and equipment capability.
- Evaluate capital equipment based on throughput, strategic capability, service, quality, labor, waste, return on invested capital, and total system impact.
- Lead major equipment selection, vendor evaluation, installation planning, startup, training, and performance validation.
- Ensure new equipment investments support Wise's strategic priorities and are not used as substitutes for process improvement.
- Coordinate capacity plans with projected business forms demand and label/packaging growth.

People and Capability Development

- Develop GMs and plant leaders to operate with a common Wise management system.
- Establish skill matrices, operator development plans, cross-training priorities, and technical succession plans.
- Improve training systems so critical manufacturing knowledge becomes standardized organizational capability rather than individual tribal knowledge.
- Help GMs build high-performing plant leadership teams with clear accountability and strong problem-solving capability.

Quality, Service, and Reliability

- Ensure consistent quality standards and disciplined quality-at-the-source practices across plants.
- Improve manufacturing lead time and delivery reliability while protecting customer quality requirements.
- Establish effective preventive maintenance and equipment reliability practices.
- Ensure significant quality, service, safety, or equipment issues are escalated quickly and resolved at the appropriate level.

VP of Manufacturing / Plant GM Operating Model

The VP should create leverage through the five experienced GMs rather than become a sixth plant manager. The following division of responsibility defines the intended operating model.

VP of Manufacturing	Plant General Manager
Owns the Wise manufacturing system	Owns daily plant execution
Owns enterprise manufacturing standards	Executes and improves standards in the plant
Develops and holds GMs accountable	Develops supervisors and operators
Owns manufacturing strategy and network capability	Owns local results and execution
Owns enterprise capacity and major capital strategy	Manages local capacity and identifies needs
Owns the Lean system and deployment approach	Leads Lean daily within the plant
Benchmarks plants and spreads best practices	Improves the plant and contributes best practices
Leads systemic problem solving across plants	Solves daily operating problems and escalates systemic issues
Builds label/packaging manufacturing capability	Implements and sustains new capabilities locally

Management Cadence

- Daily: Plant GMs run their plants through established daily management systems and escalation processes.
- Weekly: Review exceptions, constraints, lead time, service, safety, quality, major improvement work, and issues requiring enterprise support.
- Monthly: Conduct a five-plant manufacturing review using common metrics, plant comparisons, shared learning, and cross-plant improvement priorities.
- Quarterly: Review capacity, capital priorities, leadership development, Lean maturity, strategic risks, and label/packaging manufacturing growth.

Performance Scorecard

Manufacturing Performance

- Revenue per manufacturing day
- Lead time
- On-time delivery
- Throughput and constraint performance
- Makeready performance
- Waste
- Quality
- Labor productivity
- Equipment uptime and reliability

Lean and Operating System

- Deployment and sustained use of standard work and leader standard work
- Improvement in constraint throughput and flow
- Effectiveness of daily management and problem solving
- Plant Lean maturity and demonstrated continuous improvement
- Systems and processes documented and rolled out to each plant

Label and Packaging Growth Capability

- Manufacturing capacity available to support label and packaging growth
- Systems and processes documented and rolled out to each plant
- On-time completion of capability, equipment, staffing, training, and process milestones
- Successful startup and performance of new equipment and processes
- Time required to move new label/packaging opportunities into repeatable production
- Return on manufacturing investments

Leadership and Talent

- GM performance and development
- Successful hiring and onboarding of the Anderson GM
- Depth of succession coverage for critical manufacturing roles
- Operator skill development and cross-training capability

First-Year Success Outcomes

1. Hire and successfully onboard a strong Anderson Plant General Manager.
2. Establish clear VP/GM accountabilities and a common manufacturing management cadence across all five plants.
3. Define the core Wise Manufacturing System and deploy the first wave of standard work, daily management, and continuous-improvement practices.
4. Create common performance definitions and scorecards so plant-to-plant comparisons are consistent and actionable.
5. Identify the highest-impact performance gaps in throughput, makeready, lead time, waste, equipment reliability, and labor productivity, and drive measurable improvement.
6. Develop and begin executing a multi-year label and packaging manufacturing capability roadmap for the existing Wise plant network.
7. Establish a disciplined capital equipment process that links investments to strategic capability, throughput, return, service, and total system impact.
8. Build a stronger manufacturing leadership team that shares best practices and solves enterprise problems across plant boundaries.

COMPENSATION PLAN

VP of Manufacturing

Recommended Annual Bonus Scorecard

The annual incentive plan is designed to balance Wise financial performance, manufacturing operating performance, pricing and customer responsiveness, label and packaging growth capability, and development of a sustainable Lean manufacturing and leadership system.

Annual Bonus Scorecard

Measure	Weight
Wise financial performance	35%
Manufacturing operating performance	30%
Label & packaging growth / capability support	25%
Lean system & leadership development	10%
Total	100%

1. Wise Financial Performance - 35%

Primary measure: EBITDA or operating profit versus plan.

A corporate financial measure ensures the VP of Manufacturing is not rewarded solely for manufacturing metrics when Wise as a whole is not creating sufficient economic value.

Throughput matters because it ultimately creates economic value.

This is an appropriate major component of the incentive because the VP directly influences Wise financial performance through manufacturing output, pricing decisions, lead times, delivery reliability, and the responsiveness of the customer service team within the VP's reporting structure. Broader economic conditions and some commercial factors remain outside the VP's direct control, so this measure should be significant but not the entire plan.

2. Manufacturing Operating Performance - 30%

The manufacturing portion of the incentive should focus on a limited number of measures that define operational success. Plant scorecards may contain additional metrics, but the incentive formula should emphasize the few measures that matter most.

15% - Revenue per manufacturing day / throughput

Measure improvement against a pre-established baseline and operating plan.

5% - Lead time / on-time delivery / customer service responsiveness

Measures the speed and reliability of the entire customer response cycle, including manufacturing lead time, on-time delivery, and customer service responsiveness. Strong performance in these areas can directly improve customer retention, repeat purchases, and Wise's ability to win business.

5% - Makeready / productivity

Reinforces continuous improvement in Wise's high-mix manufacturing environment, where setup time and labor productivity are important drivers of throughput.

5% - Waste / quality

Ensures revenue-per-day and throughput gains are not achieved through excessive scrap, rework, or deterioration in product quality.

3. Label & Packaging Growth / Capability Support - 25%

This category should receive significant weighting during the first several years because profitable label and packaging growth is one of the principal strategic reasons for the VP of Manufacturing position.

Because the VP controls pricing and customer service and materially influences sales results through operational performance, lead times, responsiveness, capacity, quality, and delivery reliability, this component should include actual label and packaging growth outcomes as well as the manufacturing capabilities required to support profitable growth.

- Label and packaging revenue growth versus plan
- Label and packaging gross profit / contribution margin versus plan
- Pricing discipline and responsiveness consistent with approved margin and growth objectives
- Customer service responsiveness, quote/order turnaround, and support of sales opportunities
- Capacity available versus the label growth plan
- Equipment installed and operational on schedule
- New manufacturing capabilities successfully launched and work transferred into existing Wise plants
- Lead time, quality, waste, training, and production-readiness milestones achieved

This category should create direct accountability for profitable growth. Sales may originate opportunities, while the VP materially influences win rate, retention, repeat purchases, pricing realization, and margins through pricing decisions, customer service responsiveness, lead time, quality, capacity, and execution.

4. Lean System & Leadership Development - 10%

This component measures whether the VP is building the operating system and leadership capability required for continuous improvement across all five Wise plants.

- Wise Manufacturing System established
- Standard work deployed
- Daily management established
- GM leader standard work established
- SMED processes deployed
- Best practices transferred across plants
- Successor Anderson GM developed
- GMs increasingly solving problems through Lean rather than firefighting

This category should remain at 10% so the incentive does not over-reward completion of Lean activities that do not produce operating results. Lean is valuable when it translates into measurable improvements in performance.

Lean should ultimately show up in:

throughput + lead time + productivity + quality + profitability

Plan Design Principle

The incentive plan should reward current-year financial and operating results, profitable label and packaging growth, pricing and customer responsiveness, and the development of capabilities that make Wise stronger in future years. The weighting deliberately recognizes that the VP's role extends beyond factory performance: the VP directly influences revenue, margin, customer retention, and growth through pricing, lead time, responsiveness, quality, capacity, and customer service execution.